

ELITE VISA CONSULTANT

Moving to Germany from India

Complete Visa, Document & University Guide

Student • Studienkolleg • Student applicant • Language course
Ausbildung • Opportunity Card • Skilled Worker / EU Blue Card
Spouse • Dependent • Au Pair • Tourist / Visitor

- ✓ Step-by-step application for every visa
- ✓ Document checklists for every category
- ✓ Where to find courses, Ausbildung and jobs
- ✓ uni-assist, fees and university documents
- ✓ Website directory with direct links
- ✓ Customer document checklist

Information checked: October 2026

Always confirm the latest rules on the official websites before applying.

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Part 1: Introduction

Read this first. It explains how the guide works and gives a quick comparison of all visa types.

How to use this guide

This guide explains, step by step, how an Indian citizen can move to Germany to study, train, work, join family or visit. It is written so that someone with no previous experience can follow the full process from the first research to arrival in Germany.

- 1 Find the right visa.** Use the comparison table below to choose the visa that matches the person's goal.
- 2 Read the general process (Part 2).** The same basic system (online portal, appointment, biometrics, fee) applies to almost all long-stay visas.
- 3 Go to the visa's own section (Part 3).** Each section has: who it is for, where to find courses or positions, step-by-step application, a document checklist and common mistakes.
- 4 Collect documents (Part 4).** This part explains the documents used across many visas: blocked account, insurance, language certificates, APS, translations.
- 5 For students: apply to universities (Part 5).** How to find courses, uni-assist vs direct application, fees and documents.
- 6 Use the final checklists and website directory (Part 6).**
- 7 Give the customer the document checklist (Part 7).** It lists only document names, ready to print.

Important: rules and amounts change

All fees, amounts and rules in this guide were checked in October 2026. German immigration rules, salary limits and blocked-account amounts are updated regularly (usually every January). Always confirm the latest information on the official websites linked in this guide before submitting any application.

Quick comparison of all visa types

Visa	Main purpose	Typical length	Work allowed?	Visa fee
Student (Bachelor's / Master's)	Full-time degree at a German university	Course duration (visa first, then residence permit)	Yes, 140 full or 280 half days per year	€75
Preparatory course (Studienkolleg)	1-year course to qualify for a Bachelor's	Usually 1 year	Limited (check permit)	€75
Student applicant	Apply / take entrance tests from inside Germany	Up to 9 months	Limited part-time	€75
Language course	Intensive German course	Usually up to 1 year	Generally no	€75

Visa	Main purpose	Typical length	Work allowed?	Visa fee
Ausbildung	Paid vocational training (2–3.5 years)	Training duration	Yes, it is paid training	€75
Opportunity Card (Chancenkarte)	Job search in Germany	Up to 1 year	Yes, up to 20 hrs/week + trial work	€75
Skilled Worker / EU Blue Card	Job with a German employer	Up to 4 years (Blue Card)	Yes, full-time	€75
Spouse (family reunion)	Join husband/wife in Germany	Linked to partner's permit	Yes (in most cases)	€75
Dependent (children)	Children join parents	Linked to parent's permit	Depends on age	€37.50 (minors)
Au pair	Live with a German host family, help with childcare, learn German	6–12 months (only once)	Only as au pair, max 30 hrs/week	€75
Tourist / Visitor (Schengen)	Tourism, visiting family/friends	Max 90 days in 180 days	No	€90 (adults)

Fees shown are the standard fees in euros, paid in Indian rupees at the current exchange rate. Service providers such as VFS Global charge an extra service fee.

Part 2: General Process (Common to All Visas)

These basics apply to almost every visa in this guide.

Short-stay vs long-stay visa

	Schengen visa (Type C)	National visa (Type D)
Used for	Tourism, visiting family, business trips, short courses	Study, Ausbildung, work, job search, family reunion, language course
Maximum stay	90 days within any 180-day period	More than 90 days; converted into a residence permit in Germany
Where to apply	VFS Global (form filled through VIDEX or as instructed)	Consular Services Portal online, then appointment at VFS or the German mission
Standard fee	€90 adults, €45 children 6–12, free under 6	€75 adults, €37.50 minors

Where to apply in India

Germany has five visa-issuing missions in India. You must apply to the one responsible for the **state where you live**. The jurisdiction list is on the embassy website.

- Embassy of Germany, **New Delhi**
- Consulate General, **Mumbai**
- Consulate General, **Chennai**
- Consulate General, **Kolkata**
- Consulate General, **Bengaluru**

German Embassy India	https://india.diplo.de/ Visa checklists, jurisdiction list, fees and latest notices.
Federal Foreign Office	https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service Official overview of all German visa types.
Consular Services Portal	https://digital.diplo.de/visa Online application for national (long-stay) visas.
VIDEX	https://videx.diplo.de/ Online form for Schengen (short-stay) visas.
VFS Global Germany (India)	https://visa.vfsglobal.com/ind/en/deu/ Appointments, biometrics, service fees, tracking.

Step-by-step: how a national (long-stay) visa application works

- 1 Collect all documents** for your visa category using the embassy checklist and Part 3 of this guide.
- 2 Register on the Consular Services Portal** (digital.diplo.de/visa), choose the correct visa category and the mission responsible for your state.
- 3 Fill in the online application and upload PDF copies** of every document. Check that names and dates match your passport exactly.
- 4 Wait for the digital pre-check.** The mission reviews your uploads and may ask for missing documents through the portal.
- 5 Book your appointment** at VFS Global or the mission using the link/instructions you receive.
- 6 Attend the appointment** with your passport, original documents and copies. Biometrics (fingerprints and photo) are taken and the fee is paid.
- 7 Track your application** online. Processing commonly takes several weeks; plan for up to 12 weeks, especially in peak season (May–August).
- 8 Collect your passport** and check the visa sticker carefully (name, dates, visa type, number of entries).

Fees and processing times

Item	Amount / time
National visa (Type D)	€75 adults, €37.50 minors (paid in INR)
Schengen visa (Type C)	€90 adults, €45 children 6–12, free under 6
VFS service fee	Extra, set by VFS (check the VFS website)
Processing: national visas	Usually several weeks; plan for up to 12 weeks
Processing: Schengen visas	Usually around 15 days; can take longer in peak season

The visa interview

For student and some other visas, the officer may ask a few questions at the appointment. Answers should be honest, short and match the documents.

- Why Germany, and why this university, course, training or job?
- What did you study before, and how does this course connect to it?
- How are you financing your stay? (blocked account, scholarship, sponsor)
- What are your plans after the course?
- Can you briefly describe your course, city, or employer?

Tip

Read your own motivation letter and CV before the interview. Most problems happen when the spoken answers do not match what was written.

After arriving in Germany

- 1 Register your address (Anmeldung)** at the local citizens' office (Bürgeramt) within 14 days of moving in. You need your landlord's confirmation (Wohnungsgeberbestätigung).
- 2 Activate your blocked account and open a German bank account** (students and Opportunity Card holders).
- 3 Health insurance:** students switch from travel insurance to statutory (public) health insurance before enrolment; workers are insured through the employer.
- 4 Tax ID (Steuer-ID)** is sent by post automatically after Anmeldung; you need it for any job.
- 5 Residence permit:** book an appointment at the Foreigners' Office (Ausländerbehörde) **before your visa expires** to get your residence permit card.

Part 3: Step-by-Step Application for Each Visa

Each section follows the same order: at a glance, eligibility, where to find courses or positions, application steps, document checklist and tips.

1. Student Visa (Bachelor's / Master's)

Who it is for	Students with an admission letter from a German university for a Bachelor's or Master's degree.
Visa type	National visa (Type D) for study purposes; converted to a residence permit in Germany.
Work rights	Up to 140 full days or 280 half days per year, plus student assistant jobs at the university.
After graduation	Up to 18 months residence permit to look for a job matching the degree.
Fee / processing	€75 / plan for up to 12 weeks after the appointment.

Eligibility

- Admission letter (Zulassungsbescheid) from a German university, or conditional admission as accepted by the mission.
- APS certificate (mandatory for Indian students).
- Proof of funds: blocked account with **€11,904 for one year (€992 per month)**, a scholarship, or a formal sponsor declaration (Verpflichtungserklärung).
- Health insurance and the language level required by the course (English or German).

Where to find courses

DAAD International Programmes	https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/studienangebote/international-programmes/en/ Best starting point. Filter by subject, degree, language and intake.
Hochschulkompass	https://www.hochschulkompass.de/en/ Complete list of all degree programmes in Germany, including German-taught ones.
anabin	https://anabin.kmk.org/ Check if the Indian university/degree is recognised (look for 'H+').

Full details on choosing and applying to universities are in **Part 5**.

Step-by-step application

- 1 Shortlist courses (Part 5) and apply for the **APS certificate** at <https://aps-india.de> early (it can take 1–3 months).
- 2 Apply to universities through uni-assist or directly, and receive the **admission letter**.
- 3 Accept the offer and follow the university's enrolment instructions (some ask for the semester contribution in advance).
- 4 Open a **blocked account** (e.g. Expatrio or Fintiba), transfer €11,904 and download the confirmation.
- 5 Buy **health insurance** that is valid from your arrival date (travel/incoming insurance until enrolment, then public insurance).
- 6 Register on the **Consular Services Portal**, choose 'Study', fill the form and upload all documents.
- 7 After the pre-check, **book and attend the appointment** (biometrics, originals, €75 fee).
- 8 Collect the visa, book flights and arrange accommodation.
- 9 In Germany: Anmeldung, enrolment, open bank account, residence permit at the Ausländerbehörde.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ University admission letter
- ☐ APS certificate
- ☐ Blocked account confirmation / scholarship letter / Verpflichtungserklärung
- ☐ Health insurance certificate
- ☐ 10th and 12th mark sheets and certificates
- ☐ Bachelor's degree certificate and semester-wise transcripts (for Master's applicants)
- ☐ Language certificate (IELTS/TOEFL or German certificate, as required by the course)
- ☐ CV (signed and dated)
- ☐ Motivation letter explaining the choice of course and future plans
- ☐ Proof of semester contribution payment (if already paid)
- ☐ Proof of accommodation in Germany (if available)

Common mistakes

- Applying for APS too late, which delays both university and visa applications.
- Blocked account amount lower than the current requirement.
- Gaps in education or work history that are not explained in the CV/motivation letter.
- Booking flights or paying rent deposits before the visa is approved.

2. Preparatory Course Visa (Studienkolleg)

Who it is for	12th-pass students whose Indian school certificate does not give direct entry to a German Bachelor's.
What it is	A 1-year (2-semester) preparatory course that ends with an exam called the Feststellungsprüfung . Passing it allows you to apply for a Bachelor's.
Course types	T-Kurs (engineering, maths, science), M-Kurs (medicine, biology), W-Kurs (economics, business, social sciences), G-Kurs (humanities, German studies), S-Kurs (languages).
Language	Most public Studienkollegs are taught in German and require about B1 (some B2) for the entrance exam.
Cost	Public Studienkollegs usually charge only the semester contribution; private ones charge tuition.
Fee	€75 visa fee.

Do I need a Studienkolleg?

In general, the Indian 12th certificate alone does not give direct admission to a German Bachelor's. Students usually get direct admission only if they have, for example, successfully completed one or two years of a related Bachelor's in India, or qualified in JEE Advanced (for related subjects). The exact rule depends on the subject and university, so always check the course's admission requirements and the DAAD/uni-assist information before deciding.

Where to find a Studienkolleg

Studienkollegs directory	https://studienkollegs.de List of public Studienkollegs and the course types (T, M, W, G, S) each one offers.
DAAD	https://www.daad.de/en/ Information on admission requirements and preparatory courses.
uni-assist	https://www.uni-assist.de/en/ Many Studienkolleg applications go through uni-assist or the linked university.

Step-by-step application

- 1 Check if you need a Studienkolleg and which course type (T, M, W, G or S) matches your planned Bachelor's.
- 2 Learn German to at least **B1** (Goethe-Institut/Max Mueller Bhavan or another recognised school).
- 3 Apply for the **APS certificate** at <https://aps-india.de> (APS has minimum-marks rules for undergraduate applicants; check the website).
- 4 Apply to the university linked to the Studienkolleg (directly or via uni-assist) and mention the Studienkolleg course type.
- 5 Receive the **invitation to the entrance exam (Aufnahmeprüfung)** or the admission letter.
- 6 Open a blocked account (€11,904/year) and arrange health insurance.
- 7 Apply for the visa on the Consular Services Portal (student visa for preparatory course, or student applicant visa if you only have an exam invitation).
- 8 Travel to Germany, pass the entrance exam, complete the 1-year course and pass the Feststellungsprüfung.
- 9 Apply for your Bachelor's and extend your residence permit.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Admission letter or invitation to the entrance exam
- ☐ APS certificate
- ☐ 10th and 12th mark sheets and certificates (and university mark sheets, if any)
- ☐ German language certificate (usually B1 or higher)
- ☐ Blocked account confirmation
- ☐ Health insurance
- ☐ CV and motivation letter

3. Student Applicant Visa

Who it is for	People who want to be in Germany while applying to universities, taking an entrance/aptitude test, or waiting for admission.
Duration	Up to 9 months. Once admitted, you change to a student residence permit in Germany.
Work rights	Limited part-time work is allowed under current rules (check your permit).
Fee	€75

Where to find courses

DAAD International Programmes	https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/studienangebote/international-programmes/en/
Hochschulkompass	https://www.hochschulkompass.de/en/

Step-by-step application

- 1 Choose your courses and check that you meet the admission requirements.
- 2 Apply for the APS certificate.
- 3 Submit university applications (or register for the entrance exam) and keep proof.
- 4 Open a blocked account and arrange health insurance.
- 5 Apply on the Consular Services Portal under 'student applicant', then attend the appointment.
- 6 In Germany: complete the applications/tests, receive admission and convert to a student residence permit.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Proof of university application or invitation to entrance/aptitude test
- ☐ School leaving certificate that qualifies for university study (and degree for Master's)
- ☐ APS certificate
- ☐ Blocked account confirmation
- ☐ Health insurance
- ☐ Language certificate
- ☐ CV and motivation letter

4. Language Course Visa

Who it is for	People who want to do an intensive German language course in Germany (generally at least 18 hours of classes per week).
Duration	Usually up to 1 year.
Work rights	Generally not allowed.
Important	Courses shorter than 90 days use a Schengen visa instead. Changing from a language course visa to another purpose is restricted; check with the mission before applying.
Fee	€75

Where to find language courses

Goethe-Institut (Germany)	https://www.goethe.de/en/ Intensive courses in many German cities.
Goethe-Institut / Max Mueller Bhavan India	https://www.goethe.de/ins/in/en/index.html Learn German in India before you go (good for A1-B2).
DAAD language course search	https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/studienangebote/sprachkurse/en/ Search German language courses at universities and schools in Germany.

University language centres also run courses; check the website of the university in the city you want.

Step-by-step application

- 1 Choose an intensive course and book it online.
- 2 Pay the course fee (fully or as the school requires) and get the **booking confirmation**.
- 3 Arrange proof of funds (blocked account) and health insurance.
- 4 Write a motivation letter explaining why you are learning German and your future plans.
- 5 Apply on the Consular Services Portal, then attend the appointment.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Language school confirmation (course dates, hours per week)
- ☐ Proof of course fee payment
- ☐ Proof of funds (blocked account)
- ☐ Health insurance
- ☐ Motivation letter
- ☐ Previous education certificates

5. Ausbildung (Vocational Training) Visa

Who it is for	People who want paid, practical training in a profession (e.g. nursing, hospitality, IT, mechatronics, electrician, logistics, retail).
How it works	Usually 2–3.5 years. Part of the time at the company and part at a vocational school (Berufsschule). Trainees earn a monthly training salary.
Requirements	Ausbildung contract, school certificate (12th, sometimes 10th), German usually B1 , often B2 (especially nursing), approval from the Federal Employment Agency.
After training	You can stay and work in Germany as a qualified skilled worker.
Fee	€75

Where to find Ausbildung positions

Bundesagentur für Arbeit Jobbörse	https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/jobsuche/ Official government portal. Filter by 'Ausbildung'.
Make it in Germany	https://www.make-it-in-germany.com/en/ Government portal for foreigners, with information and job listings.
ausbildung.de	https://www.ausbildung.de/
AZUBIYO	https://www.azubiyo.de/
azubi.de	https://www.azubi.de/
IHK Lehrstellenbörse	https://www.ihk-lehrstellenboerse.de/ Training places registered with the chambers of commerce.

Applying directly to companies

Besides the portals, you can apply directly to companies (hospitals, care homes, hotels, IT firms, workshops) through their career page or by email. Send a German CV (Lebenslauf) and a German cover letter (Anschreiben). Applications usually open in autumn, around one year before training starts (most Ausbildung programmes start in August/September).

Step-by-step application

- 1 Learn German to **B1/B2** and get a certificate (Goethe, telc or ÖSD).
- 2 Choose the profession and search positions on the portals above.
- 3 Prepare a German CV and cover letter, and apply to many companies.
- 4 Attend interviews (often by video) and sign the **Ausbildung contract**.
- 5 The employer provides the details needed for the Federal Employment Agency approval (the employer may also start the accelerated skilled worker procedure).
- 6 If the training salary does not cover living costs, arrange additional proof of funds (blocked account or sponsor).
- 7 Apply for the visa on the Consular Services Portal and attend the appointment.
- 8 In Germany: Anmeldung, bank account, health insurance via employer, residence permit.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Signed Ausbildung contract
- ☐ Federal Employment Agency approval or employer's declaration of employment details
- ☐ German language certificate (B1/B2)
- ☐ 10th and 12th certificates and mark sheets
- ☐ German CV (Lebenslauf)
- ☐ Motivation letter
- ☐ Proof of additional funds (if salary is low)
- ☐ Health insurance (until employer insurance starts)
- ☐ Proof of accommodation (if available)

Also possible: visa to search for an Ausbildung place

There is a separate visa that allows a person to come to Germany to look for a training place for up to 9 months. Main conditions include a school-leaving certificate recognised in Germany, good German (usually B1), an age limit (under 35) and proof of funds. Check the current conditions on the embassy website before applying.

6. Opportunity Card (Chancenkarte)

The Opportunity Card started on 1 June 2024 and replaced the old Job Seeker Visa. It allows a person to come to Germany for up to **1 year** to look for a job.

Work rights	Part-time work up to 20 hours per week, plus trial work of up to 2 weeks per employer.
Proof of funds	€1,091 per month (€13,092 for one year) , via blocked account, sponsor declaration, or a part-time job contract.
Two routes	Route 1: Fully recognised qualification in Germany: no points needed. Route 2: Points system: at least 6 points + basic requirements.
Fee	€75

Basic requirements (Route 2: points system)

- A university degree or at least 2-year vocational qualification recognised by the state in India (for degrees, the university should be 'H+' in anabin).
- Language: German at least A1 **or** English at least B2.
- Proof of funds and health insurance.

How points are given

Criteria	Points
Partial recognition of qualification in Germany	4
5 years' relevant experience in the last 7 years	3
2 years' relevant experience in the last 5 years	2
German B2 or higher / B1 / A2	3 / 2 / 1
English C1 or higher	1
Age under 35 / age 35–40	2 / 1
Qualification in a shortage occupation	1
Previous legal stay in Germany of 6+ months (not tourism)	1
Spouse who also qualifies and applies together	1

Use the official self-check on Make it in Germany before applying.

Where to find jobs

Bundesagentur für Arbeit Jobbörse	https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/jobsuche/
Make it in Germany	https://www.make-it-in-germany.com/en/ Also has the Chancenkarte self-check.
LinkedIn Jobs	https://www.linkedin.com/jobs/
StepStone	https://www.stepstone.de/
Indeed Germany	https://de.indeed.com/

Step-by-step application

- 1 Check your degree in anabin and do the Make it in Germany self-check.
- 2 Get language certificates (German and/or English).
- 3 Collect experience letters, and apply for partial recognition if possible (extra points).
- 4 Open a blocked account with €13,092 (or arrange another accepted proof of funds) and buy health insurance.
- 5 Apply on the Consular Services Portal and attend the appointment.
- 6 In Germany: register, search for a job, and change to a skilled worker permit or EU Blue Card once you get a suitable job offer.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Degree certificate and transcripts
- ☐ anabin printouts (university 'H+' and degree) or ZAB statement
- ☐ Recognition notice (if any)
- ☐ Language certificates
- ☐ Work experience letters
- ☐ CV and cover letter explaining the job search plan
- ☐ Proof of funds
- ☐ Health insurance
- ☐ Proof of previous stays in Germany (if claiming points)

7. Skilled Worker Visa / EU Blue Card

For people who already have a job offer from a German employer.

Option	Main requirements (2026)
EU Blue Card	Recognised university degree, job matching the qualification, minimum gross salary €50,700/year . Reduced limit €45,934.20/year for shortage occupations (e.g. IT, engineering, science, health), graduates within 3 years of graduation, and IT specialists without a degree (with relevant experience).
Skilled worker visa	Recognised university degree or vocational qualification, and a job offer. Federal Employment Agency approval usually needed.
Experienced professionals	At least 2 years' experience and a qualification recognised in India, minimum salary €45,630/year (or employer bound by a collective agreement).
Age 45+ (first time in Germany)	Minimum salary €55,770/year or proof of adequate pension provision (does not apply to all categories).

Where to find jobs

Bundesagentur für Arbeit Jobbörse	https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/jobsuche/
Make it in Germany	https://www.make-it-in-germany.com/en/
LinkedIn Jobs	https://www.linkedin.com/jobs/
StepStone	https://www.stepstone.de/
Indeed Germany	https://de.indeed.com/
Recognition in Germany	https://www.anerkennung-in-deutschland.de/ Find out how to get your qualification recognised.

Step-by-step application

- 1 Check recognition of your degree in anabin; if needed, apply for a ZAB Statement of Comparability or professional recognition (required for regulated professions like nursing and medicine).
- 2 Search for jobs and get a written job offer/contract.
- 3 The employer fills in the 'Declaration of Employment Relationship' form. The employer may also use the **accelerated skilled worker procedure** at the local foreigners' office to speed up the process.
- 4 Apply on the Consular Services Portal and attend the appointment.
- 5 In Germany: Anmeldung, residence permit (Blue Card card), start work.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Signed employment contract or binding job offer
- ☐ Declaration of Employment Relationship (from employer)
- ☐ Degree certificate and transcripts
- ☐ anabin printout / ZAB statement / recognition notice
- ☐ Professional licence (for regulated professions)
- ☐ CV and work experience letters
- ☐ Health insurance until employer insurance starts
- ☐ Pre-approval from the foreigners' office (if accelerated procedure used)

8. Spouse Visa (Family Reunion)

Who it is for	Husband or wife of a German citizen or of a foreigner who lives legally in Germany (student, worker, Blue Card holder, etc.).
Main requirements	Both partners 18+, legally valid marriage, the partner in Germany has enough income and living space, health insurance.
German language	Usually A1 German is required. There are exceptions, for example for spouses of EU Blue Card holders and of many skilled workers and researchers. Check the embassy rules for your case.
Work rights	In most cases the spouse may work.
Fee	€75

Step-by-step application

- 1 Check whether A1 German is needed; if yes, pass the A1 exam (Goethe, telc or ÖSD).
- 2 Collect the partner's documents from Germany: residence permit, employment contract, salary slips, rental contract.
- 3 Prepare the marriage certificate. Germany does not accept apostilles on Indian civil documents; the mission may verify the marriage certificate through its own procedure (this can take extra time and fees).
- 4 Apply on the Consular Services Portal (family reunion), and attend the appointment. Some missions interview the applicant about the marriage.
- 5 In Germany: Anmeldung and residence permit at the Ausländerbehörde.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Marriage certificate (and verification documents if required)
- ☐ A1 German certificate (if required)
- ☐ Partner's passport and German residence permit (copies)
- ☐ Partner's employment contract and last 3 salary slips
- ☐ Rental contract showing enough living space
- ☐ Health insurance
- ☐ Wedding photos / proof of relationship (if requested)
- ☐ Birth certificates (if requested)

9. Dependent Visa (Children / Family)

Who it is for	Unmarried children under 18 joining one or both parents living in Germany.
Main requirements	Parent(s) have a residence permit, enough income and living space; custody rights are clear.
Language	No requirement for children under 16. Children aged 16–17 coming alone may need German C1 or proof of good integration, unless they move together with their parents or a parent holds certain permits (e.g. Blue Card).
Other relatives	Parents and other relatives can only join in limited cases; check the embassy website.
Fee	€37.50 for minors

Step-by-step application

- 1 Collect birth certificate and custody/consent documents.
- 2 Collect the parent's residence permit, income and housing proof from Germany.
- 3 Apply on the Consular Services Portal; the child (and parent/guardian) attends the appointment.
- 4 In Germany: Anmeldung, school registration and residence permit.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed online application (Consular Services Portal) and signed declarations
- ☐ Visa fee (paid at the appointment)
- ☐ Child's birth certificate
- ☐ Consent of the other parent / custody documents
- ☐ Parents' passports and German residence permits
- ☐ Proof of parent's income and accommodation
- ☐ Health insurance for the child
- ☐ School certificates (older children)

10. Tourist / Visitor Visa (Schengen)

Who it is for	Tourism, visiting family or friends, short trips. Not for work or study longer than 90 days.
Duration	Maximum 90 days within any 180-day period, valid in the whole Schengen area.
When to apply	Up to 6 months before travel, and at least 15 days before.
Fee	€90 adults, €45 children 6–12, free under 6 (plus VFS service fee)

Step-by-step application

- 1 Plan the trip: dates, itinerary, hotels or host's address.
- 2 Fill in the application form (VIDEX or as instructed on the VFS website).
- 3 Book an appointment at VFS Global.
- 4 Attend the appointment with documents; biometrics are taken and the fee is paid.
- 5 Track the application and collect the passport.

Document checklist

- ☐ Valid passport (issued within the last 10 years, valid at least 3 months after planned departure from Germany, 2 blank pages) + copies of the data page
- ☐ 2 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm, light background)
- ☐ Completed and signed Schengen application form
- ☐ Cover letter with purpose and day-by-day itinerary
- ☐ Return flight reservation
- ☐ Hotel bookings or invitation letter from host
- ☐ Formal obligation letter (Verpflichtungserklärung) if host pays expenses
- ☐ Travel insurance: minimum €30,000 cover, valid in all Schengen states
- ☐ Bank statements (last 3–6 months)
- ☐ Income tax returns (last 2–3 years)
- ☐ Employed: employer letter with leave approval + salary slips
- ☐ Self-employed: business registration; Students: college letter
- ☐ Proof of address in India

11. Au Pair Visa

An **au pair** is a young person who lives with a German host family for 6 to 12 months, helps look after the children and does light housework, and in return gets free accommodation, meals and monthly pocket money. The main purpose is cultural exchange and learning German. It is a good option for young people who want to improve their German and experience life in Germany before studying, training or working there.

Age	18 to 26 years on the date the visa application is submitted.
German language	Basic German at A1 level . If no certificate is submitted, the mission may test German at the counter.
Duration	Minimum 6 months, maximum 12 months. A person can be an au pair in Germany only once .
Host family	Must have at least one child under 18, speak German at home, and must not be related to the au pair.
Working hours	Maximum 6 hours per day and 30 hours per week, with at least 1.5 days off per week.
Pocket money	At least €280 per month , plus free private room and meals.
Insurance	The host family pays for the au pair's health, accident and liability insurance.
Other benefits	Paid holiday, and the host family usually contributes to the cost of a German language course.
Fee / processing	€75 visa fee (plus VFS service fee) / up to 12 weeks.
After the au pair year	Many au pairs later apply for a Studienkolleg, university, Ausbildung or language course visa.

Duties of an au pair

- Looking after the children: playing, taking them to school or kindergarten, helping with homework, preparing simple meals for them.
- Light housework related to the children (tidying their rooms, laundry).
- An au pair is **not** a full-time housekeeper or cleaner. Heavy housework and work beyond the agreed hours are not allowed.

Where to find host families

AuPairWorld	https://www.aupairworld.com/en Large online platform. Create a free profile, search families and chat with them.
Aupair.com	https://www.aupair.com/ Online platform to match au pairs and host families.
Gütegemeinschaft Au pair (RAL quality mark)	https://www.guetegemeinschaft-aupair.de/ Association of quality-certified au pair agencies. Use its agency finder to find trusted agencies that support you through matching, contract and visa.
Federal Employment Agency: au pair information	https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/unternehmen/arbeitskraefte/au-pair Official German information on au pair rules (in German).

Tips for choosing a host family

- Make a complete profile with clear photos, childcare experience (babysitting, siblings, teaching, school volunteering) and reference letters.
- Do at least two video calls with the family, including the children if possible.
- Ask about daily schedule, number and ages of children, city, own room, language course and free time.
- Check that the family meets all conditions (child under 18, German spoken at home, not related to you).

Step-by-step application

- 1 Learn German to A1** and pass an A1 exam (e.g. Goethe/Max Mueller Bhavan, telc or ÖSD).
- 2 Find a host family** through an online platform or a quality-certified agency (see above).
- 3 Sign the au pair contract.** It must be in German, signed by both host parents and the au pair, and show start date, duration, weekly working hours with a weekly schedule, pocket money, days off and holidays.
- 4 Host family sends documents:** filled-in host family questionnaire, invitation letter, registration certificate (Meldebescheinigung), copies of host parents' passports/ID, and insurance confirmation.
- 5 Fill in the visa application online** on the Consular Services Portal (national visa, purpose: au pair) and upload all documents.
- 6 Book the VFS appointment** using the link/instructions received after the online application (see 'Applying at VFS' below).
- 7 Attend the VFS appointment**, give biometrics and pay the fee. The mission obtains the Federal Employment Agency approval internally and may invite you for a short interview.
- 8 Collect your passport** with the visa and book your flight only after the visa is issued.
- 9 In Germany:** register your address (Anmeldung) within 14 days and apply for the residence permit at the Ausländerbehörde.

Applying at VFS Global: what happens on the day

- 1 Before the appointment:** prepare **two complete sets of copies** in checklist order (A4, no staples) and keep all originals separately. Print the appointment confirmation and online application.
- 2 Arrive 15 minutes early** at the VFS centre for your state with your passport and appointment letter. Only applicants are allowed inside; mobile phones and large bags are usually not allowed.
- 3 Security check and token:** after the security check you receive a token number for the counter.
- 4 Document submission:** the VFS staff check that the file is complete and in order. Original documents are shown for verification and returned.
- 5 Pay fees:** €75 visa fee (in INR) plus the VFS service fee. Optional services such as SMS updates or courier return can be added.
- 6 Biometrics:** fingerprints and a digital photo are taken.
- 7 Receipt:** keep the receipt with the reference number. Use it to track the application on the VFS website.
- 8 Decision:** when the status shows the passport is ready, collect it from VFS (or receive it by courier) and check the visa details carefully.

Document checklist for VFS submission

- ☐ Valid passport: issued within the last 10 years, at least 12 months validity after the planned return, minimum 2 blank pages
- ☐ Copy of passport data page (A4)
- ☐ 3 recent biometric photos (35 x 45 mm)
- ☐ Printed online application form and signed declarations
- ☐ VFS appointment confirmation
- ☐ Au pair contract in German, signed by both host parents and the au pair
- ☐ Host family questionnaire (filled in and signed by the host family)
- ☐ Invitation letter from the host family
- ☐ Host family's registration certificate (Meldebescheinigung) and copies of host parents' passports/IDs
- ☐ Proof of insurance (health, accident, liability) arranged by the host family
- ☐ German A1 certificate
- ☐ Birth certificate (with English translation if needed)
- ☐ Motivation letter (why you want to be an au pair, in German if possible)
- ☐ CV and proof of childcare experience / reference letters
- ☐ 10th and 12th certificates (and degree, if any)
- ☐ Visa fee and VFS service fee

Common mistakes

- Applicant turns 27 before submitting the application (age is counted on the date of application).
- Contract missing working hours, weekly schedule, pocket money or signatures of both host parents.
- Host family related to the applicant (not allowed).
- Weak German at the counter; prepare to introduce yourself and answer simple questions in German.

12. Other Visas (Short Overview)

Visa	Who it is for	Key documents
Business visa (Schengen)	Meetings, trade fairs, short business trips up to 90 days	Invitation from German company, letter from Indian employer, company documents, insurance, bank statements
Recognition visa	Professionals (e.g. nurses) who have partial recognition and need adaptation training or an exam in Germany	Recognition notice, German language certificate (often A2-B1), training/employer confirmation, proof of funds

Part 4: Collecting Documents

How to prepare the documents used across most visa types.

Master checklist (common to almost all visas)

☐ Passport (valid, issued within 10 years, 2 blank pages) + old passports	☐ Biometric photos 35 x 45 mm (recent, light background)
☐ Online application + signed declarations	☐ Visa fee
☐ Education certificates: 10th, 12th, degree certificates	☐ Semester-wise transcripts / mark sheets
☐ Language certificates	☐ CV (signed and dated)
☐ Motivation / cover letter	☐ Proof of funds
☐ Health / travel insurance	☐ Proof of purpose (admission letter, contract, invitation, etc.)

Translations, copies and attestation

- Documents in English or German are generally accepted. Documents in Hindi or regional languages need a translation into German or English by a sworn/certified translator.
- Most missions ask for **two sets of copies** on A4 paper, in the same order as the checklist, plus originals for verification.
- Germany does not accept apostilles on Indian public documents. For civil-status documents (marriage and birth certificates), the German mission may carry out its own verification.
- Keep names consistent in all documents. If spelling differs (e.g. in mark sheets vs passport), get an affidavit/one-and-the-same certificate.

Blocked account (Sperrkonto)

A blocked account is a special German bank account. You deposit the full amount before the visa; after arrival you can withdraw only a fixed amount each month.

Visa	Required amount (2026)
Students, Studienkolleg, language course, student applicant	€992 per month = €11,904 for 12 months
Opportunity Card (Chancenkarte)	€1,091 per month = €13,092 for 12 months

- 1 Choose a provider (e.g. [Expatrio](#) or [Fintiba](#)) and open the account online.
- 2 Transfer the amount from India through your bank (a forex/education remittance; keep the transfer receipt).
- 3 Download the blocked account confirmation and add it to the visa file.
- 4 After arrival, activate the account with your German address.

Alternatives to a blocked account

A scholarship letter, or a formal obligation letter (Verpflichtungserklärung) from a sponsor living in Germany, can also be accepted as proof of funds.

Health and travel insurance

- **Schengen visa:** travel insurance with at least €30,000 coverage, valid in all Schengen countries.
- **Students:** incoming/travel insurance from arrival until enrolment, then **statutory public health insurance** (e.g. TK, AOK, Barmer, DAK; roughly €140 per month for students).
- **Workers / Ausbildung:** insured through the employer once work starts; buy cover for the gap before that.
- **Au pairs:** the host family arranges and pays health, accident and liability insurance.
- **Opportunity Card:** private health insurance that meets German residence requirements.

Language certificates

Certificate	Language / levels	Website
Goethe-Zertifikat	German A1-C2	goethe.de (India)
telc	German A1-C2	telc.net
TestDaF	German B2-C1 (for university admission)	testdaf.de TestDaF in India (Goethe)
IELTS Academic	English (most programmes ask 6.0–7.0)	ielts.org
TOEFL iBT	English (usually 80–95+)	ets.org/toefl

APS certificate (for Indian students)

The APS (Akademische Prüfstelle) checks that Indian academic documents are genuine. It is required for university applications and the student visa for almost all Indian students.

Website	https://aps-india.de
Fee	₹18,000 (non-refundable)
Processing time	About 3–4 weeks normally; up to 3 months in peak season
Valid	Once issued, it can be used for all your applications
Note	APS has added new requirements for some applicant groups (e.g. minimum marks and new tests). Always read the latest news on aps-india.de before applying.

- 1 Register on aps-india.de and choose the correct category.
- 2 Pay the fee online.
- 3 Prepare documents as per the APS checklist (semester-wise mark sheets are needed; a consolidated mark sheet alone is not accepted).
- 4 Send the document package by courier as instructed and track the status in your account.
- 5 Receive the APS certificate and use it for uni-assist, universities and the visa.

How to organise the visa file

- Follow the exact order of the mission's checklist.
- Originals in one folder, copies (usually 2 sets) in another.
- Use A4 paper, no staples unless the checklist allows it.
- Upload clear, readable PDFs to the portal, named clearly (e.g. 'Passport.pdf', 'Admission_Letter.pdf').

Part 5: Applying to German Public Universities

This guide focuses on public universities, where most programmes have no or low tuition fees.

5.1 Finding a university and course

DAAD International Programmes	https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/studienangebote/international-programmes/en/ Best for English-taught and international programmes. Filter by subject, Bachelor's/Master's, language, intake and fees.
Hochschulkompass	https://www.hochschulkompass.de/en/ Complete database of all degree programmes in Germany (including German-taught).
anabin	https://anabin.kmk.org/ Check that the Indian university is 'H+' and how the degree is recognised.

University websites: always confirm the final requirements and deadlines on the course page of the university itself.

Types of public institutions

Type	Focus	Good for
University (Universität)	Research and theory, wide subject range	Research-oriented Master's, sciences, humanities, PhD path
Technical University (TU)	Engineering, technology, natural sciences	Engineering and technology students
University of Applied Sciences (Fachhochschule / HAW)	Practical, industry-oriented, internships included	Students who want job-ready skills

How to search effectively

- Filter by **language of instruction** (English or German).
- Filter by **intake**: Winter semester (starts October) or Summer semester (starts April). Most programmes start in winter.
- Read the **admission requirements**: required Bachelor's subjects, credits (ECTS), minimum grade, language scores.
- Note whether the programme says '**apply via uni-assist**' or '**apply directly**'.

5.2 Streams you can study

Field	Examples
Engineering and technology	Mechanical, Automotive, Electrical, Mechatronics, Civil, Chemical, Aerospace, Renewable Energy
Computer science and IT	Computer Science, Data Science, Artificial Intelligence, Information Systems, Cyber Security

Field	Examples
Natural sciences	Physics, Chemistry, Biotechnology, Mathematics, Environmental Science
Business and economics	Management, Economics, Finance, International Business, Logistics
Medicine and health	Medicine, Pharmacy, Public Health, Nursing (mostly German-taught)
Social sciences, arts and law	Political Science, Psychology, Media, Architecture, Design, Law (mostly German-taught)

- **Bachelor's:** most public Bachelor's programmes are taught in German; English-taught Bachelor's are fewer. Indian 12th students usually need Studienkolleg first (see Part 3, section 2).
- **Master's:** many English-taught options, especially in engineering, computer science and business.
- Some Master's programmes require 210 or 240 credits (a 4-year Bachelor's). A 3-year Indian Bachelor's (180 credits) may not be enough for these, so check carefully.

5.3 Direct application vs uni-assist

	uni-assist	Direct application
What it is	Central service that checks international documents and forwards them to the university	You apply on the university's own online portal
When used	When the course page says 'apply via uni-assist'	When the university runs its own portal (e.g. TU Munich, many universities of applied sciences)
Fee	€75 first course + €30 each additional course in the same semester	Usually free; some universities charge their own fee
Website	https://www.uni-assist.de/en/ Portal: https://my.uni-assist.de/	University website

Example: applying to 5 programmes through uni-assist in one semester = €75 + (4 × €30) = **€195**. Fees are not refunded if the application is rejected.

uni-assist step by step

- 1 Create an account on my.uni-assist.de.
- 2 Fill in personal details and complete educational history.
- 3 Search and select the courses you want to apply for.
- 4 Upload documents as PDFs (APS, transcripts, degree, language test, CV, motivation letter, passport).
- 5 Pay the fee online (card payment is faster than bank transfer).
- 6 Submit and track the status. uni-assist checks the documents and forwards them; the university makes the admission decision.

What is a VPD?

A VPD (Vorprüfungsdocumentation) is a document from uni-assist that converts your Indian grades to the German grading system. Some universities that use their own portal still ask for a VPD. In that case, apply for the VPD through uni-assist first, then apply directly to the university with it. Apply early, as it can take several weeks.

5.4 Costs at public universities

Cost	Amount (2026)
Tuition fee: most states	No tuition at public universities in 14 of 16 states
Tuition fee: Baden-Württemberg	€1,500 per semester for non-EU students (e.g. Heidelberg, Stuttgart, KIT, Freiburg)
Tuition fee: TU Munich (TUM)	€2,000–€6,000 per semester depending on programme (for non-EU students). Some other Bavarian institutions have also started charging; check each university.
Semester contribution (all students)	About €150–€450 per semester . It covers administration, student services and often a public transport ticket. Example: FU Berlin €376.80 for winter 2026/27.
uni-assist	€75 first application + €30 each additional
APS certificate	₹18,000
Blocked account	€11,904 per year
Health insurance	About €140 per month (public, for students)
Visa fee	€75

5.5 Documents needed for university applications

- ☐ **CV** in European/Europass format ([europass](#)), signed and dated
- ☐ **Statement of Purpose / Letter of Motivation**, written for each programme
- ☐ **Bachelor's degree certificate**, or provisional certificate (if final results are pending, many universities accept the latest semester mark sheets)
- ☐ **Transcript of records**: semester-wise mark sheets for all semesters, not only the consolidated mark sheet
- ☐ **10th and 12th** mark sheets and certificates
- ☐ **APS certificate**
- ☐ **English proof**: IELTS Academic or TOEFL iBT. A Medium of Instruction (MOI) letter is accepted by only some universities
- ☐ **German certificate**: needed for German-taught programmes (usually TestDaF 4x4, DSH-2 or Goethe C1); sometimes A1/A2 is a plus for English programmes
- ☐ **GRE/GMAT**: not required for most programmes. Some business/management and a few technical programmes require or recommend it; check the course page
- ☐ **Work experience certificates** and **internship certificates** (required for some programmes, an advantage for many)
- ☐ **Letters of recommendation (LOR)**, if asked (usually 2: academic or professional)

- ☐ **Course descriptions / module handbook / syllabus**, if asked (to show subject match)
- ☐ **Passport copy**
- ☐ **VPD** (if the university asks for it)

5.6 Timelines and deadlines

Intake	Course starts	Typical application deadline
Winter semester	October	Around 15 July (some Master's programmes close earlier, e.g. 31 May or even in winter)
Summer semester	April	Around 15 January

Planning timeline (for a winter intake)

When	What to do
12–15 months before	Research courses, check requirements, start German classes (if needed), book IELTS/TOEFL
10–12 months before	Apply for APS, take language tests, prepare CV and SOP, request LORs
7–9 months before	Get VPD (if needed), apply to universities (uni-assist / direct)
4–6 months before	Receive admissions, accept offer, open blocked account
3–4 months before	Health insurance, apply for the visa on the Consular Services Portal, book appointment
1–2 months before	Collect visa, book flights, arrange accommodation
On arrival	Anmeldung, enrolment, health insurance, bank account, residence permit

Part 6: Final Checklist and Website Directory

Final checklist

University application

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Course shortlist (DAAD / Hochschulkompass) | ☐ APS certificate |
| ☐ IELTS/TOEFL or German certificate | ☐ CV and SOP |
| ☐ LORs | ☐ Transcripts and degree |
| ☐ VPD (if needed) | ☐ Applications submitted |
| ☐ Admission letter received | ☐ Offer accepted |

Visa

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Passport and photos | ☐ Blocked account / proof of funds |
| ☐ Health insurance | ☐ Consular Services Portal application |
| ☐ Appointment booked | ☐ Copies + originals ready |
| ☐ Visa fee | ☐ Visa collected and checked |

Arrival in Germany

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Accommodation | ☐ Anmeldung (within 14 days) |
| ☐ Bank account / activate blocked account | ☐ Health insurance |
| ☐ Enrolment / start of work | ☐ Residence permit appointment |

Website directory

Category	Website	Link
Visa	German Embassy India	https://india.diplo.de/
Visa	Federal Foreign Office	https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service
Visa	Consular Services Portal	https://digital.diplo.de/visa
Visa	VIDEX (Schengen form)	https://videx.diplo.de/
Visa	VFS Global Germany (India)	https://visa.vfsglobal.com/ind/en/deu/
Courses	DAAD International Programmes	https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/studienangebote/international-programmes/en/
Courses	Hochschulkompass	https://www.hochschulkompass.de/en/
Courses	anabin	https://anabin.kmk.org/
Courses	Studienkollegs	https://studienkollegs.de
Applications	uni-assist	https://www.uni-assist.de/en/
Applications	My assist portal	https://my.uni-assist.de/
Applications	APS India	https://aps-india.de
Applications	Europass CV	https://europa.eu/europass/en
Language	Goethe-Institut	https://www.goethe.de/en/
Language	Goethe-Institut / Max Mueller Bhavan India	https://www.goethe.de/ins/in/en/index.html
Language	DAAD language course search	https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/studienangebote/sprachkurse/en/
Language	telc	https://www.telc.net/en/
Language	TestDaF	https://www.testdaf.de
Language	TestDaF in India (Goethe)	https://www.goethe.de/ins/in/en/spr/prf/testdaf.html
Language	IELTS	https://ielts.org/
Language	TOEFL	https://www.ets.org/toefl.html
Ausbildung / Jobs	Bundesagentur für Arbeit Jobbörse	https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/jobsuche/
Ausbildung / Jobs	Make it in Germany	https://www.make-it-in-germany.com/en/
Ausbildung	ausbildung.de	https://www.ausbildung.de/
Ausbildung	AZUBIYO	https://www.azubiyo.de/
Ausbildung	azubi.de	https://www.azubi.de/
Ausbildung	IHK Lehrstellenbörse	https://www.ihk-lehrstellenboerse.de/
Jobs	LinkedIn Jobs	https://www.linkedin.com/jobs/
Jobs	StepStone	https://www.stepstone.de/
Jobs	Indeed Germany	https://de.indeed.com/

Category	Website	Link
Recognition	Recognition in Germany	https://www.anerkennung-in-deutschland.de/
Blocked account	Expatrio	https://www.expatrio.com/
Blocked account	Fintiba	https://www.fintiba.com/
Au pair	AuPairWorld	https://www.aupairworld.com/en
Au pair	Aupair.com	https://www.aupair.com/
Au pair	Gütegemeinschaft Au pair (RAL agencies)	https://www.guetegemeinschaft-aupair.de/
Au pair	Federal Employment Agency: au pair	https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/unternehmen/arbeitskraefte/au-pair

Disclaimer

This guide is for general information and was checked in October 2026. Visa rules, fees and amounts can change at any time. The official websites of the German missions in India and the Federal Foreign Office are the final authority.

Part 7: Customer Document Checklist

Give this checklist to the customer. Tick the visa type and bring all documents marked for it.

Customer name: _____ **Date:** _____
Phone: _____ **File no.:** _____

Visa type (tick one)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Student (Bachelor's / Master's) | ☐ Preparatory course (Studienkolleg) |
| ☐ Student applicant | ☐ Language course |
| ☐ Ausbildung | ☐ Opportunity Card |
| ☐ Skilled Worker / EU Blue Card | ☐ Spouse |
| ☐ Dependent (child) | ☐ Au pair |
| ☐ Tourist / Visitor | |

How to bring your documents

- Bring all **original documents** and **2 sets of photocopies** on A4 paper.
- Do not staple or laminate documents.
- Names and dates must match the passport in every document.
- Documents not in English or German must be translated.

A. Documents required for ALL visa types

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Valid passport (issued within last 10 years, at least 2 blank pages) | ☐ All old passports |
| ☐ Passport data page copy | ☐ Biometric photos 35 x 45 mm (3 recent photos) |
| ☐ Aadhaar card copy | ☐ PAN card copy |
| ☐ Birth certificate | ☐ Address proof |
| ☐ 10th mark sheet and certificate | ☐ 12th mark sheet and certificate |
| ☐ Updated CV (signed and dated) | ☐ Email ID and phone number in use |

B. Student (Bachelor's / Master's)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ University admission letter | ☐ APS certificate |
| ☐ Bachelor's degree / provisional certificate | ☐ Semester-wise mark sheets (all semesters) |
| ☐ Consolidated mark sheet (if available) | ☐ IELTS / TOEFL score report |
| ☐ German language certificate (if any) | ☐ GRE / GMAT score (if required) |
| ☐ Work experience letters | ☐ Internship certificates |
| ☐ Letters of recommendation | ☐ Statement of purpose / motivation letter |
| ☐ Blocked account confirmation | ☐ Health insurance certificate |
| ☐ Scholarship letter (if any) | ☐ Sponsor documents (if any) |

C. Preparatory course (Studienkolleg)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Admission letter or entrance exam invitation | ☐ APS certificate |
| ☐ German language certificate (B1 or higher) | ☐ University mark sheets (if any) |
| ☐ Motivation letter | ☐ Blocked account confirmation |
| ☐ Health insurance certificate | |

D. Student applicant

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Proof of university application / test invitation | ☐ APS certificate |
| ☐ Degree and mark sheets (for Master's) | ☐ Language certificate |
| ☐ Motivation letter | ☐ Blocked account confirmation |
| ☐ Health insurance certificate | |

E. Language course

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Language school confirmation (dates, hours per week) | ☐ Course fee payment receipt |
| ☐ Motivation letter | ☐ Previous education certificates |
| ☐ Blocked account confirmation | ☐ Health insurance certificate |

F. Ausbildung

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Signed Ausbildung contract | ☐ Employer's declaration / employment approval |
| ☐ German language certificate (B1 / B2) | ☐ German CV (Lebenslauf) |
| ☐ Motivation letter | ☐ Proof of additional funds (if salary is low) |
| ☐ Health insurance certificate | ☐ Accommodation proof (if available) |

G. Opportunity Card

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Degree certificate | ☐ Semester-wise mark sheets |
| ☐ Degree recognition proof / statement of comparability | ☐ German certificate (A1 or higher) or English certificate (B2 or higher) |
| ☐ Work experience letters | ☐ Cover letter (job search plan) |
| ☐ Blocked account confirmation | ☐ Health insurance certificate |
| ☐ Proof of previous stay in Germany (if any) | |

H. Skilled Worker / EU Blue Card

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Signed employment contract / job offer | ☐ Declaration of employment relationship (from employer) |
| ☐ Degree certificate and mark sheets | ☐ Degree recognition proof / statement of comparability |
| ☐ Professional licence (for regulated jobs) | ☐ Work experience letters |
| ☐ Last 3 salary slips (current job) | ☐ Health insurance certificate |

I. Spouse

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|--|--|
| ☐ Marriage certificate | ☐ Marriage registration certificate |
| ☐ German A1 certificate (if required) | ☐ Wedding photos |
| ☐ Spouse's passport copy | ☐ Spouse's German residence permit copy |
| ☐ Spouse's employment contract | ☐ Spouse's last 3 salary slips |
| ☐ Spouse's rental contract | ☐ Health insurance certificate |

J. Dependent (child)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Child's passport | ☐ Child's birth certificate |
| ☐ Parents' passport copies | ☐ Parents' German residence permit copies |
| ☐ Consent letter of other parent / custody documents | ☐ Parents' income proof |
| ☐ Parents' rental contract | ☐ Child's school certificates |
| ☐ Health insurance certificate | |

K. Au pair

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Passport with at least 12 months validity after return | ☐ Au pair contract (signed by host parents and applicant) |
| ☐ Host family questionnaire | ☐ Invitation letter from host family |
| ☐ Host family registration certificate | ☐ Host parents' passport / ID copies |
| ☐ Host family insurance confirmation | ☐ German A1 certificate |
| ☐ Motivation letter | ☐ Childcare experience / reference letters |

L. Tourist / Visitor

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Cover letter with travel plan | ☐ Return flight reservation |
| ☐ Hotel booking / invitation letter | ☐ Sponsor's obligation letter (if host pays) |
| ☐ Travel insurance (min. €30,000 cover) | ☐ Bank statements (last 6 months) |
| ☐ Income tax returns (last 3 years) | ☐ Employer letter + leave approval |
| ☐ Last 3 salary slips | ☐ Business registration (self-employed) |
| ☐ College ID / bonafide letter (students) | |

Customer signature: _____

Consultant signature: _____